Humana. Claims Payment Policy

Subject: Laboratory – Identification of Select Microorganisms by Nucleic Acid Probes

Application: Medicare Advantage Products

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Medicare Advantage Payment Policy

As a Medicare Advantage plan, we have developed payment policies to explain coverage more fully for services. The criteria outlined will apply to Medicare Advantage plans except when the procedure(s) has established criteria through the Original Medicare National Coverage Determinations (NCDs) and Local Coverage Determinations (LCDs) as outlined below.

In addition to this policy, claims payments are subject to other plan requirements for the processing and payment of claims, including, but not limited to, requirements of medical necessity and reasonableness and applicable referral or authorization requirements.

- Nucleic acid identification using direct probe testing for the following organisms **IS NOT REIMBURSABLE**:
  - Chlamydia pneumoniae (CPT code 87485)
  - Cytomegalovirus (CPT code 87495)
  - Hepatitis G (CPT code 87525)
  - Herpes virus-6 (CPT code 87531)
  - Legionella pneumophila (CPT code 87540)
  - Mycoplasma pneumoniae (CPT code 87580)

- Nucleic acid identification using amplified probe testing for the following organisms **IS NOT REIMBURSABLE**:
  - Hepatitis G (CPT code 87526)
  - Herpes virus-6 (CPT code 87532)

- Nucleic acid identification using quantification testing for the following organisms **IS NOT REIMBURSABLE**:
  - Bartonella henselae or quintana (CPT code 87472)
  - Chlamydia pneumoniae (CPT code 87487)
  - Hepatitis G (CPT code 87527)
  - Legionella pneumophila (CPT code 87542)
  - Mycoplasma pneumoniae (CPT code 87582)

- Amplified probe testing for cytomegalovirus (CPT code 87496) **IS NOT REIMBURSABLE** when quantification testing for cytomegalovirus (CPT code 87497) is performed on the same date of service.

Applicable procedures for Medicare Advantage plans

Procedure Code	Code Description
87472	Infectious agent detection by nucleic acid (DNA or RNA); Bartonella henselae and Bartonella quintana, quantification
87485	Infectious agent detection by nucleic acid (DNA or RNA); Chlamydia pneumoniae, direct probe technique
87487	Infectious agent detection by nucleic acid (DNA or RNA); Chlamydia pneumoniae, quantification
87495	Infectious agent detection by nucleic acid (DNA or RNA); cytomegalovirus, direct probe technique
87496	Infectious agent detection by nucleic acid (DNA or RNA); cytomegalovirus, amplified probe technique
87497	Infectious agent detection by nucleic acid (DNA or RNA); cytomegalovirus, quantification
87525	Infectious agent detection by nucleic acid (DNA or RNA); hepatitis G, direct probe technique
87526	Infectious agent detection by nucleic acid (DNA or RNA); hepatitis G, amplified probe technique
87527	Infectious agent detection by nucleic acid (DNA or RNA); hepatitis G, quantification
87531	Infectious agent detection by nucleic acid (DNA or RNA); Herpes virus-6, direct probe technique
87532	Infectious agent detection by nucleic acid (DNA or RNA); Herpes virus-6, amplified probe technique
87540	Infectious agent detection by nucleic acid (DNA or RNA); Legionella pneumophila, direct probe technique
87542	Infectious agent detection by nucleic acid (DNA or RNA); Legionella pneumophila, quantification
87580	Infectious agent detection by nucleic acid (DNA or RNA); Mycoplasma pneumoniae, direct probe technique
87582	Infectious agent detection by nucleic acid (DNA or RNA); Mycoplasma pneumoniae, quantification

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